

Exfiltration Over Physical Medium

Sub-techniques (1) 

Adversaries may attempt to exfiltrate data via a physical medium, such as a removable drive. In certain circumstances, such as an air-gapped network compromise, exfiltration could occur via a physical medium or device introduced by a user. Such media could be an external hard drive, USB drive, cellular phone, MP3 player, or other removable storage and processing device. The physical medium or device could be used as the final exfiltration point or to hop between otherwise disconnected systems.

ID: T1052

Sub-techniques: [T1052.001](#)

 **Tactic:** [Exfiltration](#)

 **Platforms:** Linux, Windows, macOS

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[Version Permalink](#)

Mitigations

ID	Mitigation	Description
M1057	Data Loss Prevention	Data loss prevention can detect and block sensitive data being copied to physical mediums.
M1042	Disable or Remove Feature or Program	Disable Autorun if it is unnecessary. ^[1] Disallow or restrict removable media at an organizational policy level if they are not required for business operations. ^[2]
M1034	Limit Hardware Installation	Limit the use of USB devices and removable media within a network.

Detection Strategy

ID	Name	Analytic ID	Analytic Description
DET0123	Detection of Data Exfiltration via Removable Media	AN0342	Detects removable drive insertion followed by unusual file access, compression, or staging activity by unauthorized users or unexpected processes.
		AN0343	Detects mounted external devices (via /media or /mnt) followed by large file read or copy operations by shell scripts, unauthorized users, or staging tools (e.g., tar, rsync).
		AN0344	Detects mounting of external volumes followed by high-volume or sensitive file access via Finder, terminal, or third-party apps (e.g., rsync, zip).

References

1. [Microsoft. \(n.d.\). How to disable the Autorun functionality in Windows. Retrieved April 20, 2016.](#)
2. [Microsoft. \(2007, August 31\). \[https://technet.microsoft.com/en-us/library/cc771759\\(v=ws.10\\).aspx\]\(https://technet.microsoft.com/en-us/library/cc771759\(v=ws.10\).aspx\). Retrieved April 20, 2016.](#)